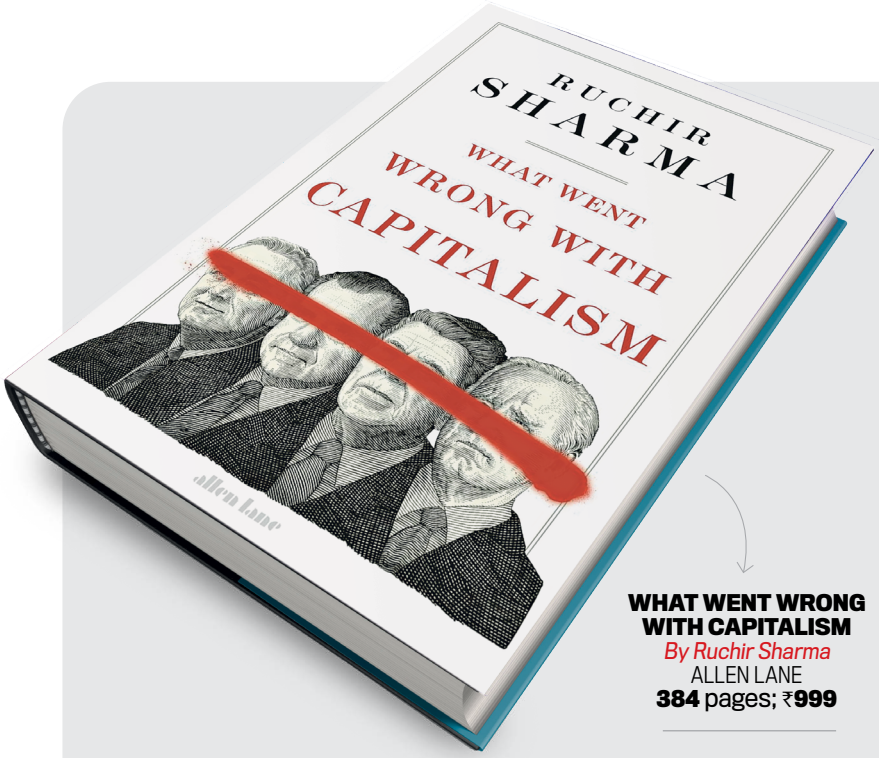


WHAT WENT WRONG WITH CAPITALISM
By Ruchir Sharma
ALLEN LANE
384 pages; ₹**999**

BOOKS

CAPITALIST DYSTOPIA

Ruchir Sharma's *What Went Wrong with Capitalism* is written for the lay reader and steers clear of jargon as it delineates the cyclical challenges faced by capitalist economies

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Ruchir Sharma is by no means a Marxist priest. For a quarter century, he helped Morgan Stanley devise capitalist investment strategies; then he became a capitalist, and founded an investment advisory firm of his own. He sat comfortably in New York, the capital of American capitalism, and presumably prospered. But he came to the uncomfortable conclusion that it was endangered, and wrote this book to warn the capitalist world.

This is not the first time that capitalism has been in danger. Ever since Francis Newcomen constructed a steam engine in 1712 to replace 500 horses, capitalism has been climbing new heights—and falling off for a while every few years. After watching the Great Depression of 1929 ravage industrial economies, John Maynard Keynes wrote *The General Theory*

BOOKS

THE END OF INNOCENCE

Sudeep Chakravarti's *Fallen City* is an in-depth account of a double murder that shook the nation in 1978

The focus of author and journalist Sudeep Chakravarti's book is the 1978 kidnap and murder of siblings Geeta, 17 and Sanjay, 15, in New Delhi. They lived with their parents, Navy captain Madan Mohan Chopra and his wife Roma, in the Service Officers' Enclave in Dhaula Kuan. On August 26, en route to the All India Radio studios on Parliament Street, the teenagers apparently hitched a ride in a Fiat, from the Gole Dak Khana roundabout. Four days later, their partially decomposed bodies were discovered in the forested area known as the Ridge.

At the time of the kidnapping, a scooterist called Inderjeet Singh Noato happened to be riding alongside the Fiat. Noticing the two young people gesticulating frantically, he gave chase. Unable to keep up, he reported the incident to the Rajinder Nagar police. Alas, their sluggish response proved to be fatal.

Eventually, the crime was fast-tracked into a country-wide hunt for the killers. On September 8, the Kalka Mail from Howrah was seven hours late and moving slowly. As it approached the Yamuna Bridge Station near Agra,

ALONG WITH THE GRIM MURDER, CHAKRAVARTI DESCRIBES A NATION SLIPPING INTO MORAL SQUALOR